

Document 2: Methodology and Work Plan

1. Introduction and Methodological Philosophy

Rubiem adopts a **risk-based, evidence-driven Post-Implementation Review (PIR) methodology** that has been successfully applied across banking and financial services institutions in Africa. Our approach is designed to provide AFC Holdings with **independent assurance, practical insights, and actionable recommendations**, while ensuring full alignment with regulatory expectations, industry best practice, and AFC's internal governance frameworks.

The methodology deliberately goes beyond a compliance checklist. It focuses on: - Whether the IDC Core Banking System is **fit for purpose** - Whether it is **stable, secure, and sustainable** in live operations - Whether the **intended business benefits** are being realised - Whether residual risks are understood, controlled, and actively managed

Given the TOR requirement that the assignment is only complete once remediation actions are independently validated, our methodology integrates **assessment, remediation planning, and validation** into a single coherent delivery framework.

2. Guiding Principles

The methodology is underpinned by the following principles:

1. **Independence and Objectivity** – All findings are evidence-based and independently validated.
 2. **Risk-Based Focus** – Review effort is prioritised on high-risk, high-impact areas such as system stability, data integrity, security, and regulatory compliance.
 3. **Business and Technology Alignment** – Equal emphasis is placed on technology performance and business outcomes.
 4. **Practicality** – Recommendations are realistic, prioritised, and implementable within AFC's operating context.
 5. **Regulatory Awareness** – Consideration of local and regional banking regulatory expectations.
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3. Detailed Methodology by Phase

Phase 1: Initiation and Planning

Objective: Establish a clear, shared understanding of scope, expectations, and success criteria.

Key Activities: - Formal project kick-off with AFC project sponsor and key stakeholders - Confirmation of scope, timelines, reporting lines, and governance - Review of key documentation including approved requirements, system design, data migration artefacts, vendor contracts, SLAs, and regulatory obligations - Development of a detailed review plan and evidence request list

Key Outputs: - Approved project plan - Evidence and data request register

Phase 2: Current-State Assessment (Technology, Data, Security)

Objective: Assess the stability, performance, and control environment of the IDC Core Banking System post go-live.

Key Activities: - Review of system performance, availability, scalability, and resilience - Assessment of infrastructure, hosting, and integrations - Validation of data migration accuracy, completeness, and reconciliation - Review of cybersecurity, access management, and segregation of duties

Key Outputs: - Technical and data assessment findings - Preliminary risk register

Phase 3: Business, Operations, and Vendor Assessment

Objective: Evaluate business adoption, operational readiness, and vendor delivery.

Key Activities: - Functional performance review - User adoption and training assessment - Review of operational support processes - Vendor performance evaluation against SLAs

Key Outputs: - Consolidated business and operational findings

Phase 4: Analysis, Reporting, and Remediation Planning

Objective: Translate findings into actionable management and Board outputs.

Key Activities: - Root cause analysis - Risk rating and prioritisation - Development of PIR report, executive summary, and remediation roadmap

Key Outputs: - Final PIR Report and Executive Summary

Phase 5: Implementation Support and Independent Validation

Objective: Independently validate remediation actions prior to closure.

Key Activities: - Tracking and validation of remediation actions - Evidence review and sign-off

Key Outputs: - Implementation Support and Validation Report

4. Six-Week Work Plan Summary

Week	Focus	Key Outputs
1	Planning	Approved plan
2	Technology & data review	Interim findings
3	Business & operations review	Validated findings
4	Reporting	Draft PIR
5	Finalisation	Final reports
6	Validation	Closure report

5. Value Proposition

This methodology provides AFC with independent assurance, clear risk visibility, and confidence that remediation actions are effective and sustainable.